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BIBLICAL ARCHÆOLOGY.

NOVEMBER, 1893,

TO

DECEMBER, 1894.

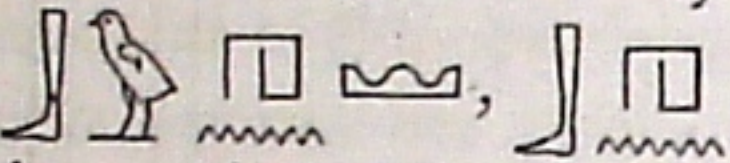
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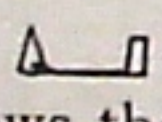
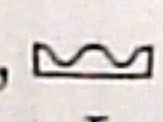
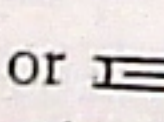
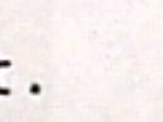
STELÆ FROM WADY HALFA.

By W. E. CRUM.

Some of the material results of Captain Lyons's excavations in Southern Egypt have reached Oxford. Four sandstone stelæ, all found in the northern Brick Temple at Halfa,* are now in the Ashmolean Museum, the keeper of which, Mr. Arthur J. Evans, has kindly enabled me to publish them here. The identification of Halfa with *Boôn* is further confirmed by these stelæ, three of which show the name , *Bwbn*, *Bhn*.

I. 17 × 15 in. Above is the disk, with wings and uræi. Below it:—

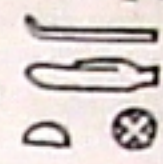
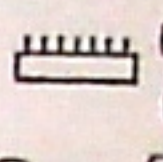
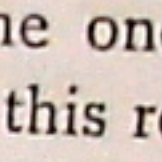
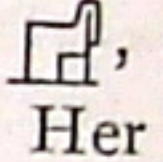
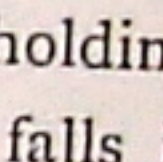


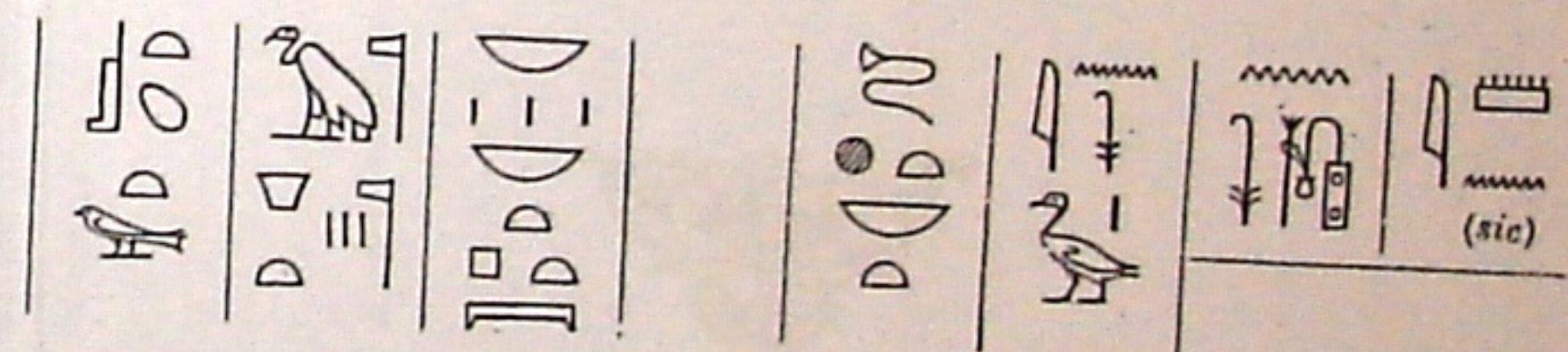
The last sign in line 5 may be ; it is not , , or . The third section of the stele shows the king, *Usrtsn I*, wearing the helmet *χprš* and embracing a deity of somewhat indistinct features. The head-dress,—the tall double feathers with uræus in front,—is clear. The face is perhaps intended for that of the local Horus. Behind the king stands an attendant, holding in his right hand the tall fan or standard, while over his shoulder are slung his master's sandals. The stele has been broken off below the hips of these figures. A part of the disk's feathers, the king's helmet, part of the fan and the face of the god are painted black (or dark blue?); the rest of the fan and the hieroglyphics are yellow.

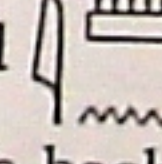
II. 12½ × 8½ in. Above is the winged disk; immediately below it were eight horizontal lines of text. But of these only the final

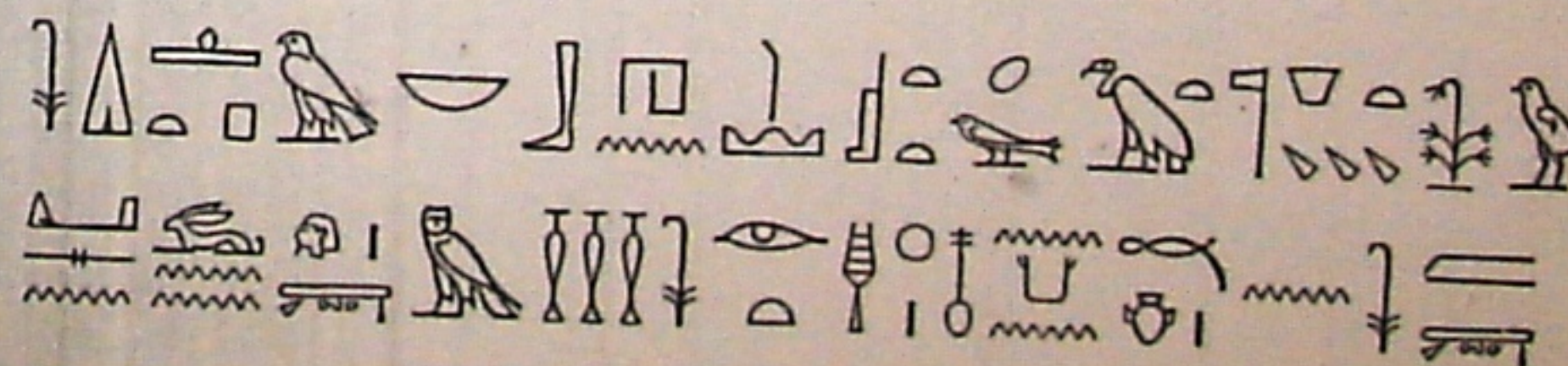
* Vide Champollion, *Not. Descr.*, I, 30, plan, at E and F; also the *Athenæum*, 19th August, 1893.

signs in each now remain, and even they are, for the most part, quite unclear. The inscription began with a "proscynema" to "[Osiris,] lord of Busiris and Horus, lord of *Boôn*." The work is very rough, and recalls that of certain semi-hieratic stelæ of the Middle Kingdom, though the form of the winged disk belongs rather to later periods.*

III. 36 × 19½ in. This stele is of fine stone and good workmanship. At the top, upon the right, is the *ut'a*; on the left is one wing of the disk , with dependent uræi, between which is the name of Thothmosis IV, ; the disk itself, immediately above, serving as the sign . The one-winged disk and *ut'a* eye seem characteristic of the stelæ of this reign.† The central register is occupied by a well wrought picture, in relief, of a goddess, seated upon the throne , and holding the emblem , and the lotus-headed sceptre. Her hair falls in long straight locks, is adorned with a wreath of white blossoms (?) and surmounted by the horned disk. Behind her head is a large scorpion. Before her stands the table of offerings, while beyond it is a space formerly filled, it seems, by a standing male figure, since erased. Between these two figures and above the table is the following text:—

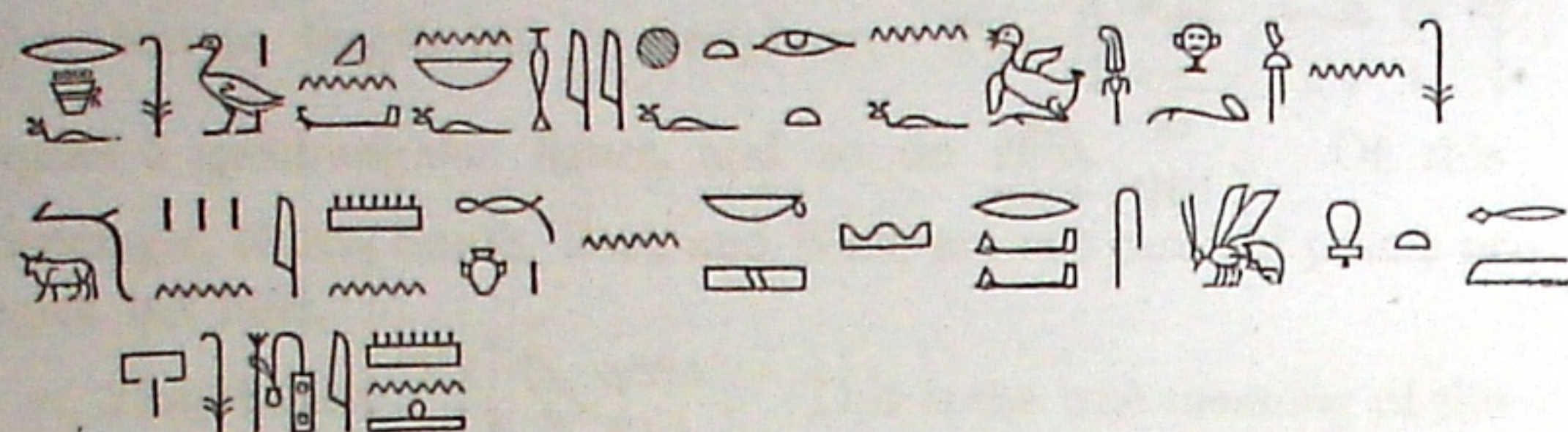


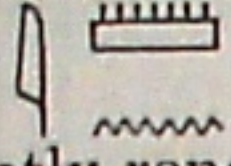
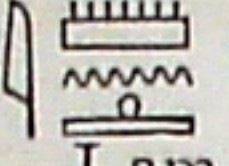
The word  appears to have been replaced, after an earlier erasure. The background of this scene is painted red, the coiffure of the goddess black. The lower portion of the stele bears four horizontal lines:—



* E.g., *Abydos*, II, 47; *Karnak*, XI.

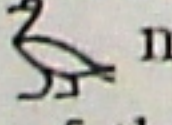
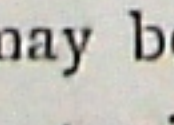
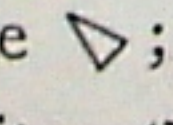
† Vide *Cat. d'Abydos*, p. 383; but occasional examples are found also later on, e.g., *Rec.*, XII, 17 (19th or 20th Dynasty).

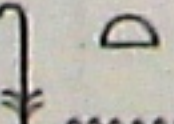
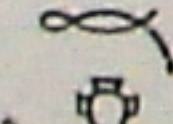
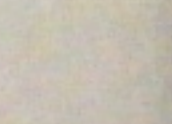


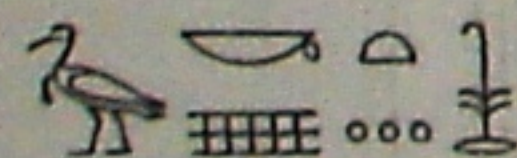
In line 4, both  and  have been erased, but the latter was subsequently renewed. I am not clear as to the meaning of *mḥ-āb n Kaš r dādās*. A possible translation is "Delighting [the King] as regards Ethiopia beyond what she produces," *i.e.*, more even than the products of Ethiopia delight him. Or it may be, "The delight of Ethiopia beyond her products," which would imply that the prince was more esteemed in Ethiopia than the native riches which the country produced.* The royal prince, in whose name the stele is inscribed, is presumably the Amenophis of Lepsius, *Denkmäler*, III, 69 a,† whom one would naturally take to be the future Amenophis III.

IV. A plain winged disk surmounts the following legends:—

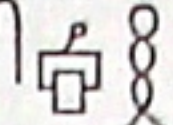
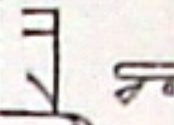
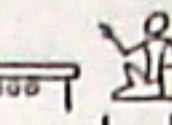
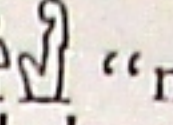
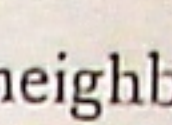
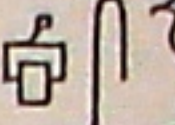
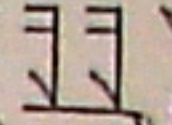
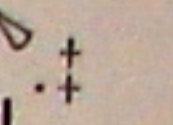


Even with the help of a squeezing, the signs terminating each of the horizontal lines are very indistinct. Below  may be ;  is quite uncertain. "The northern boundary of the territory(?) of the chief-priest (? of Horus)." But what follows? Is it the dimensions

* A somewhat similar phrase is that of *Louvre C. 2*,     



† *Vide* also Brugsch and Bouriant, *Livre des Rois*, No. 345.

of the territory? "Cultivable land, of 5 square *arura** (in extent), situated in the district of *Pr-ḥt'a*." I presume *saḥ* to be connected with       "neighbours,"† or with      .

It happens that another boundary-stone of this reign has been preserved.§ It was procured at Luxor, and shows, like the above stele from Halfa and an older boundary-stone at Semne,|| a blank space below the inscription.

It may be noted too that another stele from the same reign¶ recounts the twice repeated gift of land to the temple of Abydos.

* *Vide* Griffith, in *Proc. Soc. Bibl. Arch.*, June, 1892, 410 ff.

† Brugsch, *Wörterbuch*, *Sup.*, 1094.

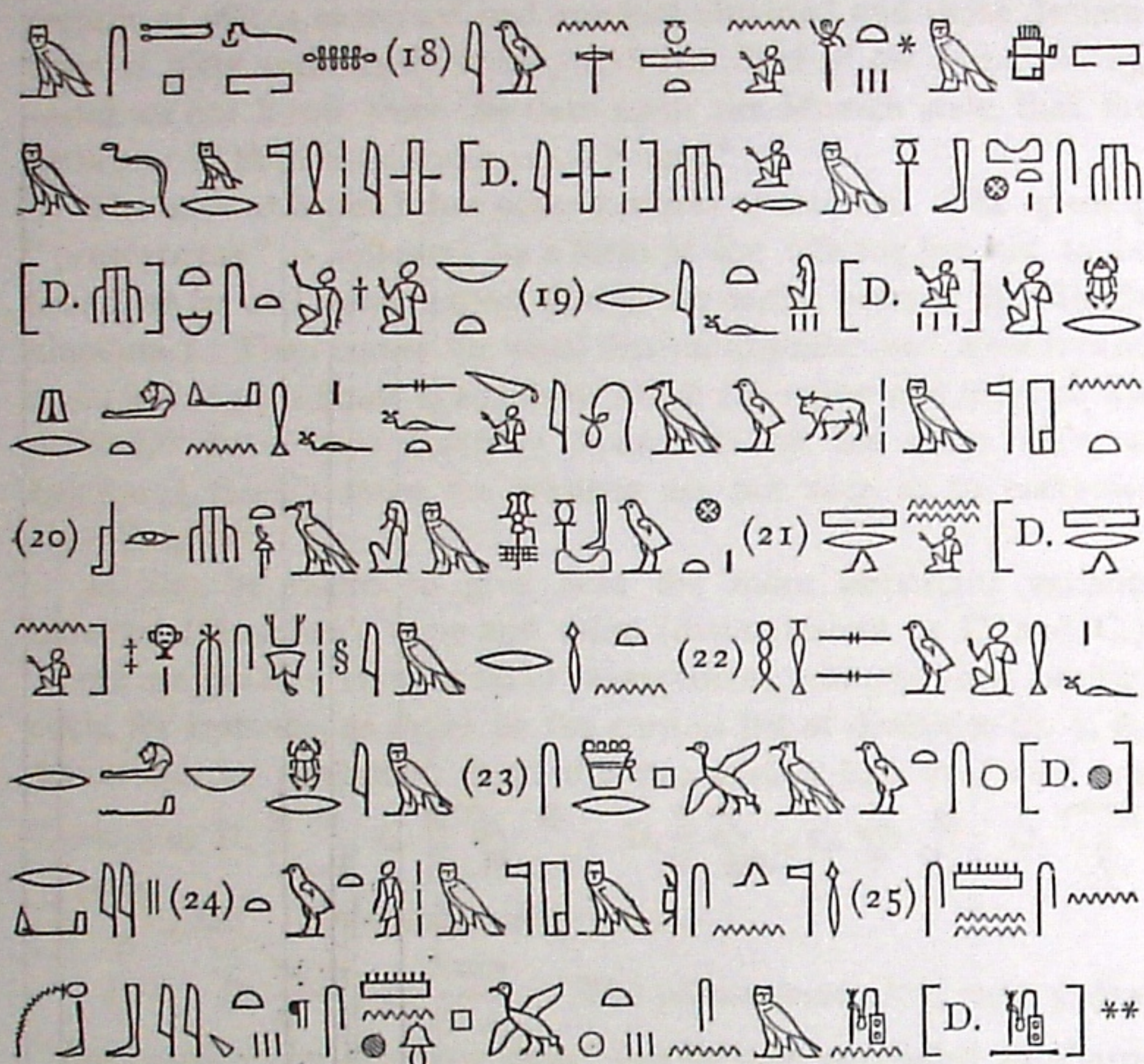
‡ Chabas, *Voyage*, &c., pl. 7, 2.

§ Mariette, *Mon. div.*, 47 a.

Lepsius, *Denkmäler*, II, 136, i.

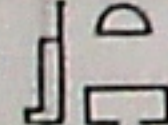
¶ *Louvre*, C. 53.



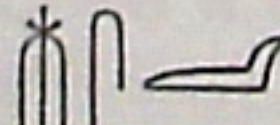


"When I voyaged northward to pay my respects to the honorable court (*lit.* that court) of his majesty, the officials that were in the king's abode and the abiders in the judgment-hall beheld my introduction at the king's abode, I doing as one that enters and speaks

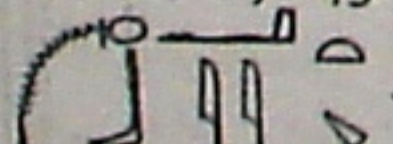
* Cf. Sharpe, I, 79, 6, where *nt'au* seems to mean "exercise offices."

† *Hmst*, instead of the  usual here.

‡ Dümichen's reading is no doubt correct; mine is untranslatable.

§ Seems the oldest form of the word; v. Ppää II, 976. Is M. Lefébure justified in identifying it, so early, with the equally ancient word ?

|| For these phrases v. *Rec.* X, 145.

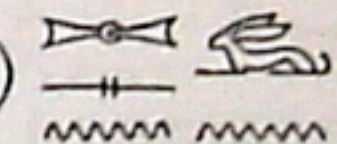
¶ *Leyden* V. 4, 13,  Cf. ? *Sint*, pl. 6, 275, .

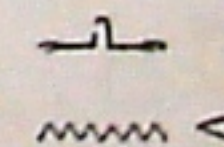
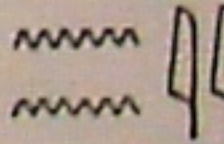
** The right reading, .

not (?). An ox was slaughtered with (= in addition to) my provisions. When (?) I arose (*lit.* raised feet) to go forth, I was praised at court and beloved in the palace. I had offices assigned to me at court, namely (those of) Overseer of the prophets and Chief *ami*χnt-priest in Abydos. Each of my posts was distinguished beyond (those of) my fathers that were before. His majesty allowed me to slaughter oxen in the temple of Osiris χnti *amntiu*, in Abydos of the Thinite nome; and I went forth over the hides there, owing to the greatness (of the favour) with which his majesty favoured me, beyond every noble that had been there since its origin (*i.e.*, the temple's); (my) statues having been placed in the temple, in the service of the "Great God"; (his majesty?) establishing for them meat-offerings (?) and endowing their bread-offerings in writing."

We may infer, therefore, that the skins used in this Abydos rite were those of the oxen previously sacrificed.

M. Lefébure writes; "La question serait de savoir si, d'après le contexte, la stèle parle d'un sacrifice fait pendant la vie ou après la mort du personnage. Si c'est de son vivant, il a été son propre

, ou *approchant*.* Cette cérémonie se compliquait certainement d'un sacrifice humain, réel ou fictif. Dans le tombeau de Mentuherkhepeshef, les deux étrangers à immoler sont enveloppés et couchés à terre, ce à quoi fait sans doute allusion une statue du Louvre (A. 65,) , "j'ai disposé l'enveloppe de l'impie (mis) sous les pieds." A Philæ, Osiris n'est

pas décapité dans Tanen;  (Bénédite, *Philæ* I, 41,) tandis que Sineh a des  à l'entrée de sa tombe (*Pap. de Berlin* I, l. 195)."

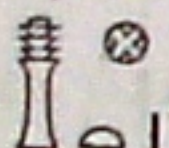
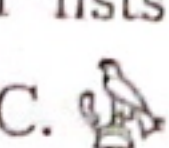
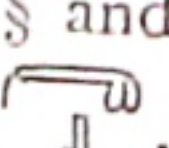
It certainly would appear that the sacrifice had taken place, with the rest of the incidents related, during the speaker's life. Yet the statements of such inscriptions might easily mislead us, at first sight, upon these points. The other stele, for example, which the same person dedicated and which is now in Leyden,† employs many expressions that would be held to refer to one already dead,—

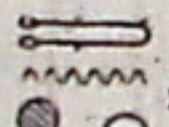
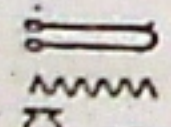
* M. Lefébure refers to the description of these rites in *Méms. de la Mission* V, 439 ff (Tomb of *Mntu hr χōsf.*);

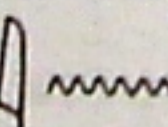
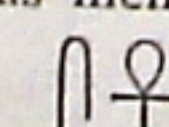
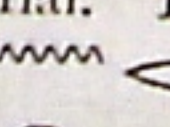
† V.

records of offices exercised and honours obtained and those declarations of piety and charity which recall the *Book of the Dead*, ch. 25, —did we not know, from the date upon the Munich stele, that the dedicator of both lived some years longer.*

The stele at Munich has other features of interest. The opening "proscynema" is followed by a form of the offering-list not to be found, so far as I know, except during the earlier years of the Middle kingdom.† Then comes the usual festival-calendar and, after it (and again in l. 15,) a blank space from which the name and titles of the dedicator have been carefully erased, as on his other stele, at Leyden;‡ though there the erasures are not such as to make the signs illegible.

It may be useful to give here the more important variants between Dümichen's copy and mine (distinguished as D. and C.). There are besides, many smaller divergencies, scarcely worth noting; such, for instance, as those in the curious list of divinities (ll. 7, 8,) which can be controlled from the two similar lists at Paris§ and Turin,|| or D. , C. ; D. , C. ; D. , C. , &c. More noteworthy are:—

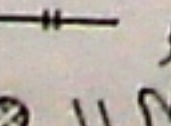
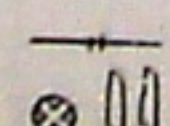
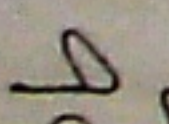
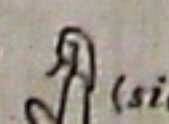
L. 6; D. , C. . The phrase *ḥnut nb(t) rnpt 5 ḥru*, "(on) each of the five extra days," can be best paralleled in Sharpe I, 25.¶

* The date at Leyden is Usrtsn I, year 44 = Ḍmnmḥāt II, year 2; that at Munich is indistinct, but cannot be earlier than Ḍmnmḥāt II, year 6 and is probably at least year 13. Erman (*Aegypten*, 234,) takes the Leyden date to be that of the dedicator's death. If that be so, the date at Munich must rather indicate the time at which the stele was erected as a posthumous memorial. But in that case, we might expect the formula,     &c., or the like.

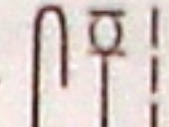
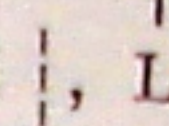
† The other examples; Piehl, 82, A. Sharpe, I, 25, *Louvre*, C. 14, *Abydos*, II, 53A.

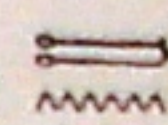
‡ Erman, l. l. Whether from design or accident, the other recurrences of the name and titles, in each of the inscriptions, have remained undamaged.

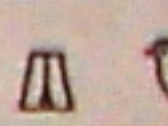
§ *Louvre*, C. 15.

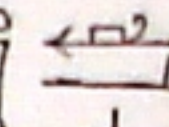
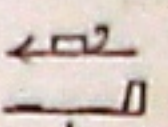
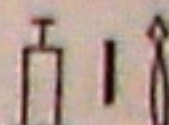
|| A.Z. '81 18 = *Rec.* III, 115. For D. , I read , and for ,  (sic) *Rpyt*, as *L.D.* II, 149 d, 9.

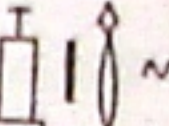
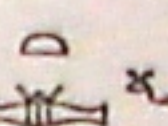
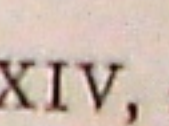
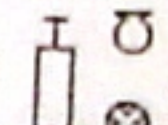
¶ Cf. M. Müller, *Rec.* IX, 174. I do not see that any other translation is here possible.

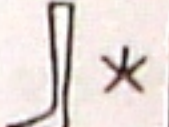
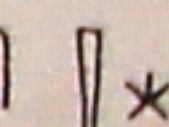
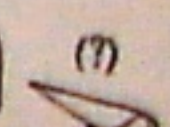
L. 7; D. , C. . The last is more probable and recurs, with doubled , *Louvre*, C. 15.

—; D. , C. .

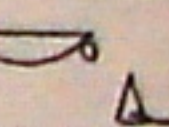
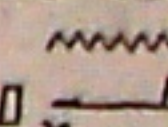
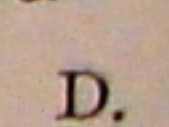
L. 9; D. , C.   .

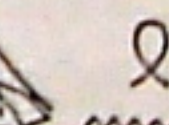
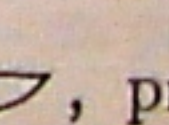
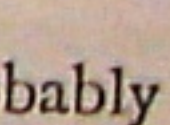
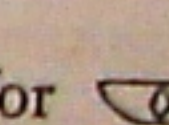
—; D. , C. . Cf. *Mon. div.*, 50 b, .

Sharpe II, 36,      . The sign is undoubtedly *ān*; v. Sharpe II, 83, (collated with the original.) . The variation between *wā* and *āa* may perhaps be compared to that in the titles *smr uāti* and *smr āa*.

—; D. , C.     . *Sba* and *sšm* are found parallel *Siut*, pl. 6, 264, *ānuk sba n mātiuf*, *sšmu uru rf*; but this does not help us much. Perhaps "initiated in the mysteries."

The next expression, *maā sft m ḥt nḥr*, "exact, accurate in sacrifice in the temple," recalls the words of the lines translated above.

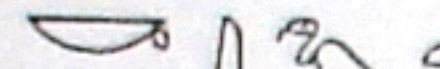
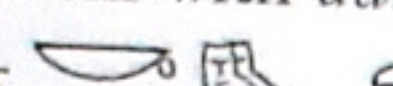
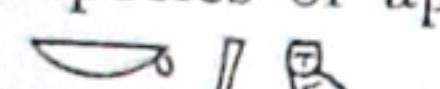
L. 14; D. , C.   . D. probably right; he agrees with two* of the four remaining texts of this formula.

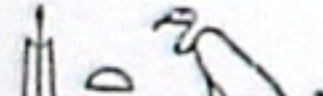
—; D. , C.      

[1894-

But the observation of the variants    *,     † pointed indubitably to the word *knmt*[ä], in Ppää I, 776:



where the duplicate, Mrnrā, 772, has  (perhaps the result of a misread hieratic group.) The parallelism with āānw (the determinative is strange), and the occurrence of  above the picture of one of three apes, Dümichen, *Temp. ins.*, I, 21, suggests that we have here the name of a peculiar species of ape. One of the 42 Assessors of Osiris is likewise named  (var. ).†

To discern the primary meaning of the root *kum* is not quite easy. The phrase Ppää I, 408 = Mrnrā 584; , "clothed in their woven-vestment," and the fact that the bearer of the title in question is sometimes dressed in a skin, while the priestly title , seems, later on, to imply that costume always, make *kum*, "to bear a hide," "to be covered, clothed," not improbable. However, there is no proof that these

However, there is no proof that these two titles are identical;

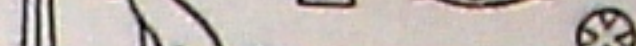
* *Rec. XIII*, 72, *R.I.H.*, 304.

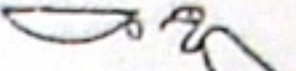
† *L.D.* II, 88 a. The variants are collected by Prof. Lushington, *Transactions*, VII, 366.

‡ Naville, *T.B.* II, 303.

§ Mastaba 167, 218, 249. But this proves little; a skir forms part of the ceremonial dress of several offices, e.g., that of the  . Cf. too the ancient title    and the use of the words   and   (e.g., P. I, 169, ib. 193 = P. II, 918.).

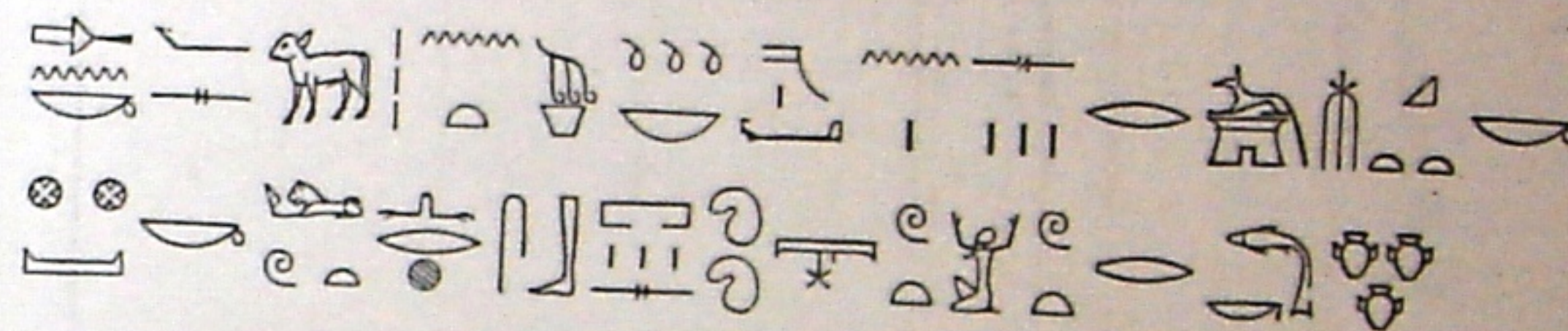
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indeed the examples  * from the Old, and 
, *mtfn*χ^t (nom. prop.)† from the Middle Kingdom,
show that this too is an ancient and so presumably independent,
word. In all cases the sign  remains difficult. It cannot but be
a separate word, of which *knmtä*, *mtf*, are the attributes or
dependent genetives.

What is the connection of our *kum* with *Harris* I, 41, a 7,


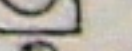
 , "a certain stone or clay"? † The his-
 tory of the roots *anm*  and *ab*  shows how these words for "skin,"
 "hide" could come to mean also the colours which the skin or hide
 displayed; and it is likewise possible that the mineral *kum* was of a
 hue which resembled that of the hide *kumt*.

P.S.—Since writing the above, M. Lefébure has sent me the following quotation from the new *Edfou* (p. 78, pl. 17):—



“Je te présente les veaux de toutes couleurs : je les amène au mystère de ta Mesek-t, ton ciel d'en bas, révére, aux portes inconnues, enténébré et éternisé pour les rebelles.” “C'est ainsi, du moins,” says M. Lefébure, “que je comprends la phrase.”

* *Mastaba* 181.

† *Rec.* III, 121. In both these instances the name is obviously that of a god; the same, no doubt, as he who appears, hawk-headed, *Abydos* II. 54, 55,  and whose "mysterious vigour" is spoken of (l.l.). *Abydos* I, 31 b, &c.,    again is the title of a priest. This double application—to god and priest—may perhaps be compared to that of *Abydos* II, 25, 3, *L.D.* II, 135 h, 11.   